elections held under the dictatorial rule of General Pervez Musharraf in 2002, the religious parties never bagged more than 2–3 per cent of the votes in general elections.

It is a misconception that 'Pakistan, created to safeguard the identity of a religion, is the realisation of a fundamentalist imagination' (Siddiqui, 2009). The founder of Pakistan, Muhammad Ali Jinnah, popularly known as Quaid-e-Azam (the great leader), who earlier advocated Muslim–Hindu unity, realised in the 1940s that Muslims could not survive politically and thrive economically in Hindu-dominated India after independence from the British rule. Therefore, it was the need envisioned by him and endorsed by the followers to safeguard the political and economic survival and well-being of the Muslims of India as a separate nation that necessitated the creation of Pakistan. It was not created because Islam was in danger of obliteration. 'Jinnah did not want to create just another state; after all, even in his day there were many Muslim states. His dream was a grand one: what he wanted was nothing less than one of the greatest nations in the world'.

The perception of 'Islam in danger' was popular among a large majority of Muslims, which was created due to historical reasons. As Lieven (2011) states:

> Underpinning intellectual and political responses by Muslim elites has been a diffuse but widespread sense among the Muslim masses of 'Islam in danger'. This sense of endangered Islam has long been fuelled not only by local or even regional events but by developments in the wider Muslim world (for example, in the later nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, the fall of the Ottoman Empire in the face of attack from Christian powers).

However, the leader was clear about the rationale of Pakistan's creation (Haqqani, 2005). Muhammad Ali Jinnah's address to the Constituent Assembly of Pakistan on 11 August 1947 clearly stated his 'fundamental principle' to run the state on the following basis:

> We are starting with this fundamental principle that we are all citizens and equal citizens of the state. You are free, free to go to your temples; you are free to go to your mosques or to any other places of worship in this state of Pakistan. You may belong to any